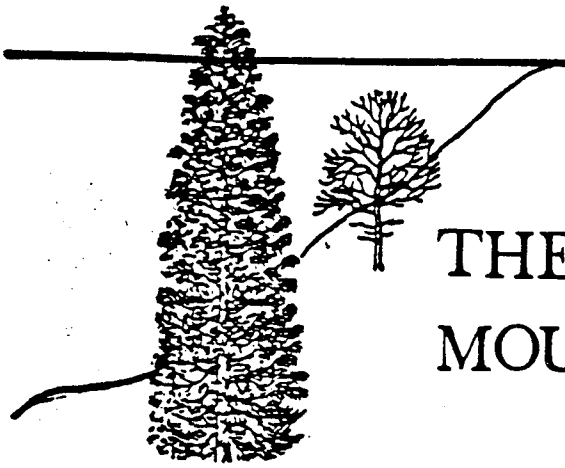


THE MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS

April 1993

Message from the President . . .

. . . *By Jim Bradfield*

Over the last few years, the May Board meeting has coincided with the annual **Clean-Up/Plant-In Day** for general membership participation. The Board believes that this year the general effort should concentrate on clearing the loop and side roads trashed by the severe rain and snowstorms the area experienced over the last three months.

The main thrust of the clean-up will be clearing the brush, leaves, and debris from the culverts and shoulders of our road system. We hope many of you will plan to attend and participate.

Those members with chain saws are especially welcome in helping us tackle the larger tree limbs blocking the culverts and shoulders.

The Board meeting, open to all members, will be held May 1 at 9:30 at the Bruels' home, P-7, and will end at noon (hopefully) so that a full afternoon can be devoted to the clean-up. Naturally, any member who wants to start his clean-up effort before noon is welcome to do so.

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Homeowners will be receiving their **six-month water fee bills** on or shortly after May 15. There are still several members whose homes are not metered. Homeowners whose meters did not or could not be read until after the November 15 beginning date for excess water fees will be gradually worked into the billing system as their six-month period is completed. All homeowners will be billed for the flat monthly charge of $10 per month which began November 15. Members are urged to promptly pay their water bill.

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Still on money matters, the Board believes it is appropriate to announce that the **notices of assessment and due date are going to be strictly enforced** beginning with FY-94. Notices of the regular assessment will be mailed out in late June with a July 1 due date and a penalty for non-payment to take effect on July 31. The Board does not condone partial payments that stretch out over a period of months past the 30-day grace period into late and interest penalty periods. The Board has approved raising the late penalty fee to $50, up from $15.

While this announcement may be premature, the Board does not anticipate any reduction in the assessment schedule approved at the last General Meeting: lot with house, $850; unimproved lot, $300. Members should anticipate receipt of the annual assessment letter in late June rather than the usual September 1 date to enable CMA to reconcile the billing date with the beginning of the fiscal year.

Again, early payment in June is encouraged. As mentioned at the last General Meeting, the Association has a history of experiencing a cash crunch at the beginning of the fiscal year until the general assessments were received during the month of September -- hence, **the urgency for prompt payment.**

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The Board has recently turned its attention to the issue of approval of the **construction of unusually large houses**. We are also concerned over the strain such construction might impose on the Association's infrastructure for roads, water, and sewer services. We have discussed this with the Ashelmans. Also, we have in preparation a letter to the general membership outlining this situation and seeking their comments.

Over the last few months, the Board has been reviewing our position regarding the **final payment to BBI**, the company that constructed the wetlands project. The issue has been whether we should pay the final payment knowing that there is the strong possibility of a mechanic's lien against us by BBI's subcontractor who is suing BBI.

We have assured BBI we are prepared to pay the final draw of the construction contract provided BBI furnishes the required waiver of liens.

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The Board is pleased to announce that we have reached a verbal agreement with Sam Ashelman on the **repair of the damage to the loop road**. As soon as the agreement is signed by Mr. Ashelman, we hope to begin repair of the North Loop section.

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CDC has received another extension of time for completing the **"S" section**, owing to the bad weather and the fact that the road has not passed compaction tests.

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Members are reminded again that the **speed limit** on the Loop and side roads is 15 miles per hour. Members who rent are asked to remind their tenants to observe the speed limit for the safety of members and guests.

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New Members: We are pleased to welcome George and Elizabeth Notter who have purchased lot R-9. Their address is 1740 New Hampshire Ave., N.W., Apt. G, Washington, D.C. 20009; home (202) 783-2524, office (202) 296-2700. Please add their name to your membership list.

Don't Forget!

May 1

Spring Clean-Up, Debris-Clearing, Have-Fun Project

Join Your Neighbors in Beautifying the Mountainside

We Look forward to Seeing You All